CASH TO COMPANY · GRADE 11

a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

The Year, Architected

Big ideas, year-at-a-glance, vocabulary, and the project arc.

Grade 11 year theme — Leadership, Sales, and Execution.
The 9-12 band is built for the adults who will scrutinize: parents, teachers, administrators.

9-12 BAND · HIGH SCHOOL

CURRICULUM BOOK

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Grade 11 · Curriculum Book · the magazine version of the master document, set for adults to read end-to-end.

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GRADE 11 · CURRICULUM BOOK

The Year, Architect

Leading three people, listening to one customer, executing six weeks.

11

Year theme: Leadership, sales, and execution **Grade band:** 9-12 (high school) — band anchor **Total instructional time:** ~36 weeks · 2–4 periods per week, depending on schedule **Anchor mascot:** Cash, the program's animated host (now in 9-12 voice) **Cross-grade hook:** bridges from Grade 10 (Ownership structure) to Grade 12 (Launch-ready entrepreneurship)

WITH CASH - 9-12 VOICE

"Which people, and how do you know?"

Why this year

YEAR ARC - PROJECT INTENSITY BY UNIT

Intensity = student artifacts produced + cash-flow stakes + team interdependence.

> "Don't make up a winner. Decide what to test next."
>
> - CASH, GRADE 11

Junior year is the year reality moves in. Most Grade 11 students are simultaneously deciding what they'll be after high school, holding their first jobs with real W-4s, fielding license-and-insurance conversations, and weighing college decisions with cost implications they can read on a page. Cash to Company at Grade 11 leans into that reality without exploiting it. The year teaches the moves of running a venture or running a team — leading, selling, executing under cash constraints — and grounds those moves in financial discipline strong enough to survive contact with real money.

The signature shift this year is from "I have a business idea" to "I can run a multi-person, multi-month operation under uncertainty." Students lead 3-person teams, run sales conversations, build 12-month cash flow forecasts, and deliver investor-style pitches. The Capstone is a 6-week venture sprint that must show traction, not just plans. Grade 11 is the

band anchor for high school: it is where the big ideas of 9-12 stop being theoretical and start being demonstrable.

The previous year (Grade 10) gave students the legal, structural, and capital scaffolding — sole prop versus LLC, funding-source comparison, premortems, ownership vocabulary. Grade 11 puts those scaffolds under live load. Next year (Grade 12) takes whatever Grade 11 produced and runs it to a Launch-or-Learn decision in front of a real panel. So Grade 11 is the muscle year — the year where students actually do the work that an adult founder would recognize as work.

The big ideas (Understanding by Design — Stage 1)

Six understandings drive this year. Every unit, lesson, and capstone artifact traces back to one or more of these.

1. **Leadership at 16 is mostly about clarity, follow-through, and earning the trust of three people for four weeks.** It is not charisma. The skill is naming what's true, naming what you'll do, and doing it.
2. **A great sales conversation is structured listening with a clear ask.** It is not a pitch with a smile. Discovery is more than half the conversation; the close is a clear sentence.
3. **Profit is an opinion. Cash is a fact.** Cash flow timing — when money arrives versus when it leaves — kills more small ventures than bad ideas do. The 12-month forecast is the year's most consequential artifact.
4. **Execution under uncertainty looks like a backlog of small, named experiments — not one big bet.** Real founders run hypotheses, pick a metric, test, and decide. They do not "just hustle harder."
5. **Investors and judges don't reward enthusiasm; they reward learning.** The "what we learned" slide is often the most important slide. A team that says "here's what didn't work and what we'd do next" outperforms the hype team.
6. **Ethics is a load-bearing wall, not a poster.** Truthful claims, healthy work hours, and non-deceptive pricing are the guardrails that let a venture survive its second year. A "no-go list" is a leadership move, not a limitation.

Essential questions (returned to all year)

- What does it look like to lead three people for four weeks without a title?
- How do I run a sales conversation where the customer leaves heard, not pitched?
- Which month does my cash get tightest, and what do I do before that month arrives?
- Which experiment should we run next, and what would have to be true for us to stop?

- What evidence do I have — and what evidence do I need — before I'd ask a real adult for real money?
- What will I refuse to do, even if it works?

Year-at-a-glance — four units

Unit	Weeks	Title	Big idea	Anchor capstone artifact
1	1–8	Leading without authority	Leadership at this age is mostly clarity, follow-through, and earning trust.	Team charter + 4-week sprint with weekly 1:1 logs and a written retrospective.
2	9–18	Sales is structured listening	Selling well looks like a conversation, not a pitch.	Recorded 5-step sales role-play, peer-scored on the 6-criterion rubric, plus a written self-critique.
3	19–28	The cash flow truth	Profit isn't cash. Cash is what keeps you alive.	12-month cash flow forecast for the Capstone venture, with the tight month named and two specific fixes.
4	29–36	Execute under uncertainty	A backlog of small experiments beats one big bet.	6-week venture sprint: 5 named experiments, 5 tracked metrics, a 5-minute investor-style pitch with a "what we learned" slide.

The Capstone is the 6-week sprint in Unit 4 — students execute a real or simulated venture for six weeks, run 5 named experiments, track leading and lagging metrics, and deliver a 5-minute investor-style pitch with a Q&A panel. Capstone teams are formed in Unit 1 and held all year. The team charter is not a warm-up exercise; it is the operating agreement for the venture sprint.

Strand outcomes (Master Scope, verbatim)

This year addresses all eight strand outcomes. CBM (sales conversation) and LTO (4-week team lead) carry the heaviest load and define the year's character. The verbatim outcomes from the Master Scope and Sequence:

- **BAVC.** I can analyze a successful local business (interview or case study) and identify three decisions that drove its growth.
- **PSIG.** I can take a stalled venture (mine or a case) and produce a 5-experiment "growth backlog" with hypothesis, test, and metric for each.

- **MFL.** I can build a 12-month cash flow forecast (cash in, cash out, ending cash) and identify the month where cash gets tightest, with a fix.
- **CBM.** I can run a structured sales conversation (open, discover, present, handle one objection, close) in a role-play and self-score against a rubric.
- **OSO.** I can use a project management tool (board-style or list-style) to manage a 6-week venture sprint with weekly check-ins and demo days.
- **LTO.** I can lead a 3-person team through a 4-week project with a written team charter, weekly 1:1s, and a final retrospective.
- **ESL.** I can identify and apply 3 ethical guardrails (truthful claims, healthy work hours, no deceptive pricing) and write a "no-go" list for my venture.
- **LRCI.** I can deliver a 5-minute investor-style pitch with traction slide, ask, and "what we learned" — and incorporate panel feedback into a revision.

Standards alignment (verbatim from Standards Alignment Map)

> **"Most adults skip this step. You won't."**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 11

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 12-4:** Apply systematic decision-making to long-term goals.
- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 12-2:** Explore career paths of interest — including entrepreneurship as a path.
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 12:** Income from self-employment is not the same as profit — explicitly taught in cash-flow forecasting.
- **CCSS-Math A-REI.D.10 / F-LE.A.1:** Linear, exponential, quadratic models — applied in cash-flow forecasts and growth projections.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.11-12.4:** Present information, findings, and supporting evidence — investor-style pitch.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.11-12.3:** Evaluate a speaker's point of view, reasoning, and use of evidence — applied to peer pitch critique.
- **C3 D2.Eco.13.9-12:** Explain why advancements in technology and investments in capital goods and human capital increase economic growth.
- **CASEL Relationship Skills:** Conflict management, leadership.

- **NGSS-ETS HS-ETS1-3:** Evaluate a solution to a complex real-world problem based on prioritized criteria and trade-offs.

Vocabulary roadmap (22 weight-bearing terms)

Vocabulary is layered and recycled. Each unit introduces 5–7 new terms; old terms return in later units with higher load. Students keep a Vocabulary Spine in the Capstone Journal and build a Frayer model for 8 weight-bearing terms across the year.

Unit 1 — Leading without authority (6): charter, retrospective, RACI, 1:1, dependency, accountability.

Unit 2 — Sales is structured listening (6): open question, discovery, value-fit, objection-handling, honest claim, close.

Unit 3 — The cash flow truth (5): cash flow, runway, working capital, sensitivity, tight month.

Unit 4 — Execute under uncertainty (5): hypothesis, experiment, traction, leading vs. lagging metric, pivot vs. persevere.

Recycled / spine vocabulary from earlier years: unit economics, contribution margin, persona, premortem, MVP, COGS.

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 11

"Which people, and how do you know?"

the program's spine question.

1

Anchor texts and short reads

- The Hard Thing About Hard Things (Ben Horowitz) — teacher-mediated 2-page summary on the difference between leading in good times and leading in hard times. (No purchase required; program packet provides excerpt.)
- Never Split the Difference (Chris Voss) — kid-curated handout on tactical empathy and labeling, used in the sales unit. The 7-question discovery script is adapted from this source.
- A founder origin story written for the year — short read on a local-scale founder who survived a tight month. Two versions provided (a tutoring service and a small food vendor) so the example matches student venture types.
- Lean Startup (Eric Ries) — single-page summary on the Build-Measure-Learn loop. The vocabulary "experiment" and "pivot vs. persevere" comes from here.
- One Cash video per major unit beat (8 across the year — see the Video Scripts file).
- Two short pitch decks (one strong, one weak) for the Unit 4 critique cycle. Provided in the program assets.

Project arc — the Capstone Venture Sprint

Across the year, each 3-person team develops one venture — a real local-scale offer (tutoring, repair service, content product, event service, kit-style retail) or a convincing simulation. The Capstone has four checkpoints, one per unit, plus the final 6-week sprint:

- **End of Unit 1 (Week 8):** Team Pack — written charter, 4-week sprint log, weekly 1:1 notes, and retrospective.
- **End of Unit 2 (Week 18):** Sales Pack — recorded 5-step role-play with self-score, peer-score, and a 1-page "objections we expect and how we'll respond" memo.
- **End of Unit 3 (Week 28):** Cash Pack — 12-month cash flow forecast, tight-month analysis, and a 1-page memo on two fixes.
- **End of Unit 4 (Week 36):** Sprint Pack — 6-week sprint with 5 experiments logged, 5 metrics tracked, traction slide, and the investor-style pitch delivered to a real panel.

Teams are formed in Week 3, locked by Week 4, and held through Week 36. Pivot windows (where teams can change ventures, not teams) open in Weeks 9, 19, and 29. Team-composition changes are rare and require teacher sign-off; the year is partly a test of working with a fixed group through difficulty.

Assessment philosophy

Assess two things at every checkpoint:

1. **Did the team do the work the standard names?** Real role-plays, real forecasts, real sprints, real pitches. The recording exists. The spreadsheet computes. The panel was watching.
2. **Did the team think about it?** Each pack includes a "what we got wrong on the first try" memo and a "what we'd do differently next sprint" line. Reflection is a learning goal, not garnish.

Use the program's analytic rubrics from the Rubric Bank: Business Plan Rubric (Unit 4 plan), Pitch Presentation Rubric (Unit 4 final), Budget Project Rubric (Unit 3 forecast), and Reflection Writing Rubric (every retrospective). Holistic scoring is allowed only for Cash-video reflections and weekly exit tickets.

Differentiation in Grade 11

> **"Profit is an opinion. Cash is a fact."**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 11

- **ELL.** Sales conversations and 1:1s are language-rich. Provide sentence frames and the discovery question bank in advance. Allow native-language brainstorming on the role-play, English on the recorded version. Pair with an ally on the first attempt at any new conversation type.
- **IEP/504.** Recorded role-plays can be audio-only. Forecasts can be reduced from 12 months to 6 months on first build. Charters can be drafted as bullet points before prose. Provide structured templates with one section per page.
- **Advanced learners.** Push toward depth — multi-segment sensitivity analysis on the forecast, a downside scenario at -30% revenue, an additional "objection from a hostile customer" round in the sales unit, peer-coaching role on retros. The 5-experiment growth backlog can be expanded to 7 experiments with explicit dependencies.

Sensitivity considerations specific to this year

- **Real money is in the room.** Many Grade 11 students hold jobs with real paychecks. Avoid asking about family income, debt, savings, or housing situation. Use "for a hypothetical 16-year-old" framing for case-study math. The curriculum norm is that no student is asked to share family financial details, ever.

- **Sales pressure and consent.** Selling skill, in the wrong hands, becomes manipulation. The "honest claim" criterion in the sales rubric is non-negotiable. Coach students to notice the line between persuasion (helping someone see how a product fits their stated need) and manipulation (creating urgency, fear, or social pressure). The year's ethics anchor lives here.
- **Working hours and burnout.** Hustle culture can creep into a sprint unit. Cash explicitly names healthy work hours as one of the three ethical guardrails. The capstone rubric does not reward sleep deprivation; it rewards learning velocity.
- **Team conflict.** A 4-week team lead will surface conflict. Coach toward direct, kind, specific language. Some teams will need teacher mediation in Week 5 or 6. Treat that as part of the curriculum, not a failure of it.
- **Comparative wealth in pitches.** Some student ventures will assume parental funding for supplies (a $300 website, a $500 inventory order). Coach toward bootstrapped versions. The Capstone can be done entirely on $0 with a friend's website and word-of-mouth distribution.

Materials and tools

- A digital project-management tool (Trello, ClickUp free tier, GitHub Projects, Notion free tier, or paper Kanban). Required for the Unit 4 sprint.
- A spreadsheet tool (Google Sheets, Excel for Web). Required for the Unit 3 forecast.
- A phone or tablet with audio/video recording for sales role-plays.
- The Capstone Journal (notebook, paper or digital).
- The Student Activity Book (provided).
- Eight Cash videos (2:30–3:00 each — see the Video Scripts file).
- Pitch panel: a small group of adults — local entrepreneurs, parents, school staff — for the final pitch in Week 36. Recruit by Week 30.

How this year hooks into the rest of Cash to Company

- **Reaches back to Grade 10.** Students bring forward the funding-source comparison, the operating agreement, and the sole-prop-versus-LLC reasoning. Those structural choices now meet live cash flow and live customers.
- **Reaches forward to Grade 12.** The 6-week sprint produces a venture with traction (or honest learning) that becomes the seed for Grade 12's Launch-or-Learn decision. The pitch deck, forecast, and sales recordings become Grade 12 portfolio assets.
- **Vertical strands.** Each of the eight strands has a Grade 11 outcome (see Master Scope). The four units braid them: Unit 1 is LTO + OSO, Unit 2 is CBM + ESL, Unit 3 is MFL + LRCI, Unit 4 braids all eight with a center of gravity on PSIG and BAVC.

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 11

"Most adults skip this step. You won't."

the band's working assumption.

2

A note to first-time teachers of this curriculum

You do not need to have run a business to teach this. You do need to be willing to hold the line on evidence and honesty when the work gets messy. Teams will ask you to settle disputes you should not settle ("tell my teammate to do X"); coach them back to the charter. Students will pitch ventures with magical thinking ("we'll go viral"); ask "which people, and how do you know?" until the question is answered or the venture is honest about its uncertainty.

The Cash videos take some pressure off introducing concepts; the lesson plans take the pressure off pacing. Your highest-leverage move is enforcing two norms: which people, and how do you know? and what's the honest claim? By Week 16, students will ask these of each other before you do. By Week 32, the strongest teams will ask them of themselves.

A note to the student reading this

> **“Some of this is hard because the world's hard. The skill is knowing what's in your hands.”**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 11

You are about to lead three people for four weeks. You are about to record yourself selling and watch the recording and find one thing you would change. You are about to build a 12-month spreadsheet that will tell you something true about your venture you did not know. You are about to run a 6-week sprint where some experiments will fail and some will work and the most important slide in your pitch will be the one labeled "what we learned."

You will be wrong. You will be tired. You will get one piece of feedback that stings before you can hear it. You will also, by June, be able to do something that almost no other 16-year-old in your school can do: run a real operation, with real cash math, in front of real adults, and tell the truth about what worked and what did not.

That is the deal. Cash will keep asking the same question all year. Get good at answering it.

— The Cash to Company team

Senior expert upgrade pack — Grade 11

Multi-class branching scenario — "Two cash flow forecasts"

A 2-day branching scenario for Unit 3 (cash flow truth).

- **Day 1.** "Two student ventures have the same annual revenue: $24,000. Same costs: $20,000. Same annual profit: $4,000. But different timing."

Month	Founder A: Cash in	Founder A: Cash out	Founder B: Cash in	Founder B: Cash out
Jan	$0	$5,000	$2,000	$1,667
Feb	$0	$5,000	$2,000	$1,667
Mar	$0	$5,000	$2,000	$1,667
Apr	$24,000	$5,000	$2,000	$1,667
May–Dec	$0	$0	$2,000 × 8	$1,667 × 8

Founder A: gets paid in April only (large client check). Founder B: monthly subscription revenue.

Class question: who runs out of cash first? When? What's the fix?

Compute together: Founder A goes negative at $5,000 in cash needed by end of Jan, $10,000 by end of Feb, $15,000 by end of Mar. They need a $15,000 line of credit or savings to survive until April. Founder B never goes negative — small monthly cushion.

- **Day 2.** Pivot: "Founder A negotiates 25% upfront, 75% on delivery. How does the cash flow change?" Recompute.

Month	Cash in	Cash out	Ending cash
Jan	$6,000 (25% of $24k)	$5,000	$1,000
Feb	$0	$5,000	−$4,000
Mar	$0	$5,000	−$9,000
Apr	$18,000 (75% of $24k)	$5,000	$4,000

Now Founder A only needs $9,000 of cushion. Better, but still tight.

This scenario practices MFL (cash flow), LRCI (revising the plan when cash gets tight). Repeatable with: a lawn-care business with seasonal revenue, a tutoring service with quarterly billing.

Hiring basics — a one-page reference (real venture readiness)

Real Grade 11 ventures sometimes hit the moment a founder needs help. The current curriculum doesn't cover this. Add:

- **When to hire a contractor.** When the work is outside your skill (logo design, accounting, ad management) AND the cost of doing it yourself (time × your hourly value) is more than the contractor's fee.
- **What a 1099 is.** A 1099 contractor is independent — you pay them, they handle their own taxes. Different from an employee (W-2 + payroll taxes).
- **A 1-paragraph scope of work.** "I want [contractor name] to deliver [specific outcome] by [date] for [fee]. Payment due [terms]. Either party can end with [notice]." Five sentences. That's a real scope.
- **Kill criteria.** Before you hire: write down what would make you stop the relationship. Quality? Missed deadlines? Vibe? If you can't articulate when to stop, you can't start cleanly.

This reference is recycled at Grade 12.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Standards Citations (verbatim)

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 12-4:** "Apply systematic decision-making to long-term goals."
- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 12-2:** "Explore career paths of interest" — including entrepreneurship as a path.
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 12:** "Income from self-employment is not the same as profit" — explicitly taught in cash-flow forecasting.
- **CCSS-Math A-REI.D.10 / F-LE.A.1:** "Linear, exponential, quadratic models" — applied in cash-flow forecasts and growth projections.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.11-12.4:** "Present information, findings, and supporting evidence" — investor-style pitch.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.11-12.3:** "Evaluate a speakers point of view, reasoning, and use of evidence" — applied to peer pitch critique.
- **C3 D2.Eco.13.9-12:** "Explain why advancements in technology and investments in capital goods and human capital increase economic growth."
- **CASEL Relationship Skills:** Conflict management, leadership.

- **NGSS-ETS HS-ETS1-3:** "Evaluate a solution to a complex real-world problem based on prioritized criteria and trade-offs."

ROUND 2 PATCH — Strand Outcomes (verbatim)

By end of Grade 11, a student can: - **BAVC:** "I can analyze a successful local business (interview or case study) and identify three decisions that drove its growth." - **PSIG:** "I can take a stalled venture (mine or a case) and produce a 5-experiment growth backlog with hypothesis, test, and metric for each." - **MFL:** "I can build a 12-month cash flow forecast (cash in, cash out, ending cash) and identify the month where cash gets tightest, with a fix." - **CBM:** "I can run a structured sales conversation (open, discover, present, handle one objection, close) in a role-play and self-score against a rubric." - **OSO:** "I can use a project management tool (board-style or list-style) to manage a 6-week venture sprint with weekly check-ins and demo days." - **LTO:** "I can lead a 3-person team through a 4-week project with a written team charter, weekly 1:1s, and a final retrospective." - **ESL:** "I can identify and apply 3 ethical guardrails (truthful claims, healthy work hours, no deceptive pricing) and write a no-go list for my venture." - **LRCI:** "I can deliver a 5-minute investor-style pitch with traction slide, ask, and what we learned — and incorporate panel feedback into a revision."

ROUND 2 PATCH — Cross-Grade Bridge: Grade 11 → Grade 12 (FORWARD bridge, REQUIRED)

You spent this year leading a 4-week team, building a 12-month cash flow forecast, running a 6-week venture sprint, and delivering an investor-style pitch with revision. **The sprint evidence and pitch revision are the input for next years portfolio defense.** Bring forward: your sprint board, your 12-month forecast, your pitch (and the revision), and your retrospective. Grade 12 begins by taking inventory of what you would and wouldnt build — and your Grade 11 work is the data.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Forward-reference Grade 9 Conflict-Style Self-Assessment

You named your conflict-handling style two years ago — avoid, accommodate, compete, compromise, or collaborate. **Bring it forward into this years team work.** As you lead a 3-person team for 4 weeks, watch your default. Does your team need more of one mode and less of another? Your retrospective should name the mode you exercised and the mode you under-used.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Advanced-Learner Specifics (Grade 11)

- **Cash flow extension:** Build a 3-year cash flow forecast with reasonable growth and seasonality. Identify three potential cash-tight periods.
- **Growth backlog extension:** Run two of the 5 experiments in parallel. Compare which taught more. Discuss the value of parallel testing.
- **Sales extension:** Run sales role-plays in two customer types (B2C and B2B-lite). Discuss what changes between them.
- **Hiring extension:** Write a scope of work for a complex contractor engagement (e.g., "build my landing page" with 5+ deliverables and ambiguous quality criteria). Defend the scope.

ENDNOTES & STANDARDS

Citations and alignment

Grade 11 cites 3-6 standards across CCSS, Jump$tart, CEE, CASEL, and C3 frameworks. Detailed alignment lives in the master Standards Alignment Map.

1. **Jump$tart Coalition Personal Finance Standards (2021 ed.).** Spending and Saving; Credit and Debt; Employment and Income; Investing; Risk Management and Insurance; Financial Decision Making.
2. **Council for Economic Education (CEE).** Voluntary National Content Standards in Economics.
3. **CCSS-ELA, Grades 11-12.** W.11-12.1, W.11-12.4, SL.11-12.1, SL.11-12.4, RST.11-12.7.
4. **CCSS-Math.** N-Q.1-3 (Reasoning with Quantities), S-IC (Statistics & Inferences), F-IF (Functions), MP.4 (Modeling).
5. **CASEL Core Competencies.** Self-Awareness, Self-Management, Social Awareness, Relationship Skills, Responsible Decision-Making.
6. **C3 Framework for Social Studies State Standards.** Dimension 2 (Economics, Civics) at the high-school grade band.
7. **NGSS-ETS Engineering Practices.** ETS1 (Engineering Design) for the test-and-iterate spine of the year.
8. **Cash to Company Master Scope & Sequence.** 13 grades x 8 strands x 36 weeks; outcomes quoted verbatim from _master/00_Master_Scope_and_Sequence.md.
9. **Cash Mascot Style Guide.** 9-12 voice rules: multi-sentence arguments; vocabulary includes unit economics, runway, premortem, MVP; never flatters, never promises wealth.
10. **Sensitivity protocol.** No probing of family finances; financial scenarios framed as hypothetical for a sample household, business, or scenario.

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move t
program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepren
matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We pro

> **“Leading three people, listening to one customer, executing six weeks.”**
>
> **- CASH, GRADE 11**

For educational use. This curriculum is informational and does not constitute financial, legal, or tax advice. Standards alignment cited per the Cash to Company Standards Alignment Map (Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS-ETS).